- Use the cleanest water available for making weaning foods and for washing uncooked foods.
- If possible boil the water if it has not come from a clean source such as a tap or water pump.
- Boiling water will kill the germs that cause diarrhoea.
- Do not store weaning foods for more than two hours if possible.
- Keep them stored in clean covered containers that keep out flies and other insects.

8.7 Maternal and Child Health services

Maternal and Child Health services include the curative, preventive and social aspects of maternity services, paediatrics, family welfare, nutrition, child development and health education. The specific objectives of MCH are:

- Reduction of morbidity and mortality rate for mothers and children
- Promotion of reproductive health and
- Promotion of the physical and psychological development of the child within the family.

Components of MCH

- Family planning and reproductive health service
- Maternal, newborn and child health service
- Health Communication
- Health Commodities and supplies
- Health systems strengthening

The Ministry of Health and Family Welfare has launched National Health Mission in May 2013. Many different health and welfare programmes have been brought together under the umbrella of National Health Mission (NHM) with National Rural Health Mission (NRHM) and National Urban Health Mission (NUHM) as its two sub missions. The programme components include Reproductive-Maternal-Newborn-Child and Adolescent Health (RMNCH+A); and control of communicable and non communicable diseases.

Reproductive, Maternal, Newborn, Child and Adolescent Health (RMNCH+A)

This programme has been launched in 2013. It aimed to reduce the maternal mortality and child mortality and addressed the delays in accessing and utilizing health care and services. Under this programme, the areas of care include

- Reproductive care
- Maternal care
- Neonatal care
- Child care and
- Adolescent health care

The three goals that are relevant to RMNCH+A strategic approach in 12th Five Year Plan which has to be achieved by 2017 is as follows:

- Reduction of Infant Mortality Rate (IMR) to 25 per 1,000 live births
- Reduction in Maternal Mortality Ratio (MMR) to 100 per 100,000 live births
- Reduction in Total Fertility Rate (TFR) to 2.1

Priority interventions in RMNCH+A

The following are the intervention for children. They are

- Home-based newborn care and prompt referral
- Facility-based care of the sick newborn
- Integrated management of common childhood illnesses (diarrhoea, pneumonia and malaria)
- Child nutrition and essential micronutrients supplementation

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